

Korea Financials & Fintech: HK/SG marketing feedback: A solid value choice to weather turbulent markets

Rising interest in KR financials as investors rotate into non-tech defensives

With the tech sector correcting sharply, we saw a shift in investor interest towards non-tech ideas, driving increased demand for KR banks shares. Investors agree that KR banks are in a sweet spot given increased volatility, a likely flight to safety and a continued commitment to shareholder return. Since the Value Up narrative is well-established in the market, investor focus has shifted towards the ROE upside potential from the rate hike cycle and the retail money move.

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KR Banks seen as a safe haven backed by macro tailwinds and the ROE upside

With strong macro supporting the rate hike cycle, investors agree that KR banks' profit can strengthen via bigger NIM expansion and resilient asset quality, translating into a higher-than-consensus ROE delivery. While investors remain skeptical about elevated brokerage profits — noting that increased market volatility could dampen retail trading sentiment, we believe major banks' Value Up renewals (i.e., raising the TSR ceiling and setting the minimum floor at 50%) alongside continued TSR expansion will allow major KR banks to reach 1x P/B.

KR insurers put on the radar as the next candidates for Value Up theme

While we expect an improving underwriting cycle aided by reform initiatives (i.e., GA commission cap, stricter claims review) and insurers shifting their focus to quality over quantity, investors are waiting for substantial refinements to Value Up plans that are perceived as primitive. Moreover, we see growing external pressure given the gov't-led corporate governance reform measures (i.e., mandatory treasury share cancellation, 3% rule on major shareholders' voting rights) as well as peer pressure from DBI which is looking to announce more detailed measures in mid-Aug, 2026.

Fintech sentiment subdued by lending curbs; waiting for stablecoin developments

Although a handful of investors inquired about KakaoBank's margin expansion potential as an upside risk to the consensus estimates, overall investor interest remained muted. This is primarily due to the gov't further tightening retail lending, which has led major internet-only banks to aggressively lower their maximum overdraft limits or temporarily suspend new account issuance. Meanwhile, despite Kakaopay delivering accelerated revenue growth via its brokerage subsidiary, investors appear to be waiting for tangible stablecoin related developments that can potentially level up its growth trajectories.

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Exhibit 1: Summary valuation table for Korea Financials/Fintech coverage

Ticker	Company	Mkt Cap (KRW bn)	3M ADTV (KRW bn)	Rating	TP	Last Price	Up/Down side	P/B		P/E		ROE		ROA		Div. Yield		TSR Yield	
								2026E	2027E	2026E	2027E	2026E	2027E	2026E	2027E	2026E	2027E	2026E	2027E
Korea Banks																			
105560.KS	KB Financial Group	67,003	222	Buy	214,000	168,800	26.8%	1.01x	0.91x	8.4x	7.2x	11.8%	12.5%	0.80%	0.85%	2.9%	3.4%	5.8%	7.0%
055550.KS	Shinhan Financial Group	48,167	143	Buy	123,000	101,800	20.8%	0.83x	0.74x	8.1x	6.7x	10.5%	11.5%	0.71%	0.78%	2.9%	3.3%	6.4%	8.0%
086790.KS	Hana Financial Group	39,911	110	Buy	159,000	133,400	19.2%	0.74x	0.67x	7.6x	6.4x	10.7%	11.5%	0.65%	0.71%	3.5%	4.0%	5.8%	6.8%
316140.KS	Woori Financial Group	22,056	72	Neutral	37,000	30,550	21.1%	0.61x	0.55x	6.5x	5.4x	9.5%	10.4%	0.53%	0.61%	5.1%	5.9%	6.9%	8.4%
323410.KS	KakaoBank Corp.	10,714	23	Neutral	26,000	22,550	15.3%	1.59x	1.51x	16.9x	15.1x	9.4%	10.3%	0.80%	0.81%	3.0%	3.3%	-	-
139130.KS	iM Financial Group	3,028	13	Neutral	16,500	17,900	-7.8%	0.50x	0.44x	5.2x	4.5x	9.4%	9.9%	0.50%	0.53%	4.5%	4.9%	6.8%	7.9%
024110.KS	Industrial Bank of Korea	12,149	30	Sell	17,000	21,200	-19.8%	0.52x	0.49x	6.1x	5.7x	8.1%	8.2%	0.51%	0.51%	5.7%	6.1%	-	-
38930.KS	BNK Financial Group	5,769	21	Sell	14,000	17,700	-20.9%	0.48x	0.41x	6.5x	5.7x	7.8%	8.1%	0.50%	0.53%	3.5%	4.2%	6.3%	7.2%
Korea Insurance																			
000810.KS	Samsung F&M	23,977	104	Buy	800,000	602,000	32.9%	0.65x	0.62x	11.2x	8.2x	7.6%	8.0%	2.16%	2.73%	3.9%	5.8%	-	-
005830.KS	DB Insurance	10,064	39	Buy	190,000	159,000	19.5%	0.94x	0.85x	6.9x	5.9x	13.8%	15.1%	2.39%	2.64%	5.5%	6.3%	-	-
001450.KS	Hyundai M&F	2,926	19	Buy	48,000	36,700	30.8%	0.49x	0.42x	3.4x	3.1x	15.7%	14.4%	1.70%	1.80%	0.0%	8.2%	-	-
032830.KS	Samsung Life	54,142	153	Neutral	335,000	301,500	11.1%	0.37x	0.36x	18.3x	8.7x	2.8%	4.2%	0.75%	1.36%	2.5%	5.3%	-	-
138040.KS	Meritz FG	21,708	33	Sell	100,000	113,000	-11.5%	1.50x	1.16x	7.4x	6.4x	25.4%	24.2%	1.85%	1.90%	1.2%	1.2%	6.6%	6.8%
088350.KS	Hanwha Life	3,242	37	Sell	2,900	4,315	-32.8%	0.30x	0.29x	7.0x	6.5x	4.6%	4.6%	0.36%	0.37%	-	-	-	-
Korea Fintech																			
323410.KS	KakaoBank Corp.	10,714	23	Neutral	26,000	22,550	15.3%	1.59x	1.51x	16.9x	15.1x	9.4%	10.3%	0.80%	0.81%	3.0%	3.3%	-	-
377300.KS	Kakaopay Corp	5,356	20	Neutral	58,000	39,700	46.1%	2.61x	2.35x	34.6x	24.4x	7.8%	10.2%	2.64%	3.26%	-	-	-	-

Based on 20 July 2026 closing price; all target prices are on a 12-month basis; TSR yield is applicable to companies implementing share buybacks/cancellation

Source: Quantwise, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

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